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## LARGE The Crimson Ledger of Ecktoria

### Political Intrigue in the Marble City

A Fate's Edge OneShot Adventure

#### largeADVENTURE OVERVIEW

**Premise:** The legendary Crimson Codex, containing every secret of Ecktoria's elite, has been stolen, causing cascading social collapse as magically enforced oaths break

**Theme:** Political intrigue, social collapse, and the power of truth

**Focus:** Social Investigation

**Combat:** Low Combat Optional

**Length:** OneShot

#### largePREMISE TONE

In the marble forums of Ecktoria, where the Utaran Empire's ghosts still echo through colonnaded halls, the city's greatest scandal isn't political—it's literary. The Crimson Codex, a legendary book of forbidden knowledge said to contain every secret, every lie, and every truth that could destroy the city's elite, has been stolen from the Library of Keys.

But this isn't just any theft. The Codex was bound in oaths—literally. Each page was a magically enforced secret, kept by the weight of sworn vows. Now those oaths are breaking, and as they do, Ecktoria's power structure is crumbling. Senators confess to treason in their sleep, merchants reveal the locations of their hidden vaults, and the High Priest of the Everflame begins preaching heretical sermons about the "true" history of the Empire.

#### largeTHE HOOK

The PCs are hired by Livaea, the Crimson Courtier, to recover the Codex before the city tears itself apart. But Livaea has her own agenda—the Codex contains the location of the Red Branch, a splinter faction of the old Utaran nobility who vanished centuries ago but may hold the key to restoring the Empire.

The twist? The theft was orchestrated by Inaea, Angel of the Spider, working through a network of blackmail victims who finally found the courage to fight back. The breaking oaths aren't a bug—they're a feature. And the Codex is writing itself as it's read, with each secret revealed adding new pages of devastating truths.

#### largeFRONTS TIMERS

Secrets Unbound [6/8] This timer tracks the cascading revelation of secrets throughout Ecktoria.

**Advances when:** Major secret revealed, failed social manipulation (DV 4+), Patron Rite affecting social structures, choosing Inaea's path over Livaea's

**Segments:** Minor scandals emerge; gossip spreads faster  
**Moderate complications:** Significant NPC makes public confession, tem  
**Major social disruption:** Major social disruption

Inaea, Angel of the Spider **Tags:** Patron, WebWeaver, TruthBringer  
**Approach:** Wits 5, Spirit 4, Presence 3, Body 2  
**Skills:** Insight 5, Investigation 4, Sway 3, Lore 4  
**Talents:** Strand of Inevitability, Snaring Filament, WebSense  
**Harm:** 5timer; Armor: 1  
**Special:** WebSense +2 dice to detect hidden connections and leverage  
**Agenda:** Expose all corruption; break unjust bonds; let truth rebuild society  
High Priest Valeria the TruthSpeaker **Tags:** Religious Authority, Heretic, Chosen Voice  
**Approach:** Spirit 4, Presence 3, Wits 3, Body 1  
**Skills:** Command 4, Lore 5, Faith 4, Insight 3  
**Talents:** Divine Authority, Prophetic Sight, Sacred Texts  
**Harm:** 3timer; Armor: 0  
**Special:** Chosen Voice Words carry divine weight, +2 Effect to declarations

#### largePATRON INTERACTION

##### Livaea's Offers

tem **Binding Vow:** Stabilize a crumbling alliance. Gain +1d to social rolls with that faction, but mark 1 Obligation. tem **Sovereign Glamour:** Create a perfect social situation. Next social scene begins with Dominant Position, but generate 1 SB (Hearts). tem **Token of Favor:** Gain temporary ally's support. +1 Effect to one action, but the ally marks 1 Exposure.

##### Inaea's Offers

tem **Strand of Inevitability:** Reveal hidden connection. Gain +2 dice to Investigation about target, but mark 1 SB (Diamonds). tem **Snaring Filament:** Set social trap. Next hostile NPC suffers 1d to social rolls, but you mark 1 SB (Spades). tem **Merciful Severing:** Break harmful tie. Remove one Condition or SB, but mark 1 Fatigue from the release.

#### largeECKTORIA DISTRICTS REACTIVE STATES

The Grand Forum (Law Order) p0.2p0.4p0.3 **State Effects Social DV Modifier**  
line Orderly Bureaucracy functions normally Base DV  
Chaotic Contracts failing, magistrates arguing +1 DV  
Purges Zealous investigations, false accusations Desperate Position  
Reconciliation Forgiveness sought, old debts forgiven Controlled Position

The CoinHouse Floor (Commerce) p0.2p0.4p0.3 **State Effects Financial DV Modifier**  
line Stable Normal negotiations, sealed ledgers Base DV

Anarchic Frantic deals, bankruptcies +2 DV  
Speculative Wild investments, rumors drive prices 1 DV (but risk)  
Collapse Markets frozen, credit worthless Desperate Position

The Basilica of the Everflame (Religion) p0.2p0.4p0.3 **State Effects Ritual DV Modifier**

line Orthodox Rigid doctrine, formal rites Base DV  
Ecstatic Truthseeking, spontaneous worship +1 Effect  
Doubting Faith shaken, rituals uncertain +1 DV  
Fanatical Zealous purges, forced conversions Desperate Position

## THE CRIMSON CODEX MECHANICS

Reading the Codex

tem **Risk:** Wits + Arcana DV 4. On failure, generate 1 SB. On partial, choose one:tem Reveal truth but mark 1 Fatigue tem Gain insight but generate 1 SB (Diamonds) tem Learn secret but mark 1 SB (Hearts)

tem **Rewards:** Successful reading grants:

tem +1d to Investigation about related topics tem One specific truth about target NPC/faction tem Advantage on social rolls against target (once)

Codex Backlash Table When reading fails or generates SB, roll 1d6:

tem Your secret revealed to nearby NPCs tem Target of your investigation becomes aware tem Patron (Livaea or Inaea) gains leverage over you tem New complication timer starts (24 segments) tem Harm 1 (Mental stress from forbidden knowledge) tem Gain permanent Condition: TruthSensitive (1d to deception)

## INVESTIGATION AND SOCIAL CHALLENGES

The Web of Oaths Create a visual map of key NPCs and connections:

tem Political (red lines) tem Financial (gold lines) tem Romantic (pink lines) tem Blackmail (black lines with arrows)

As oaths break, lines snap or change color. Players can:

tem **Sever** (Inaea): Cut one connection, but generate 1 SB tem **Reinforce** (Livaea): Strengthen one connection, but mark 1 Obligation tem **Redirect:** Change target of connection, but require Wits + Sway test

## largePOTENTIAL TWISTS

**The Red Branch's True Agenda** The exiled nobles aren't returning to restore the Empire they want to reclaim their lost artifacts and disappear again, using the chaos as cover. The Codex might be their key to finding these items.

**Reveal:** When PCs investigate the Red Branch, they discover plans for a "quiet extraction" rather than a glorious return.

**The Chosen Voice** The High Priest isn't mad; she's been chosen by the Codex itself to be its voice, preaching the "truth" it contains.

**Reveal:** During a religious ceremony, her eyes turn crimson when reading from any text, and she speaks prophecies that later prove true.

**Personal Secrets** A PC's own secret is contained within the Codex. Reading it or being near it causes them to involuntarily reveal it, or grants the Patron leverage over them.

**Implementation:** Each PC writes down one secret during character creation. When Codex Rewriting advances, GM may reveal one PC secret.

## largeGM GUIDANCE

Running the City Make Ecktoria feel alive by:

- tem Describing changing atmospheres in districts
- tem Having NPCs react differently based on district state
- tem Using the Secrets Unbound timer to trigger district shifts
- tem Letting player actions have visible consequences on city mood

Patron Balance Present both Patrons' offers as:

- tem Equally tempting within their frameworks
- tem Logically consistent with their natures
- tem Carrying clear, immediate costs
- tem Leading to different longterm consequences

Social Combat Treat social encounters like combat:

- tem Establish clear stakes and consequences
- tem Use Position to reflect social advantage
- tem Let timers drive escalating tension
- tem Reward creative solutions and roleplay

## largeCHARACTER INTEGRATION

**For Runekeepers** The abundance of oaths and secrets makes Oathbased Rites incredibly potent:

- tem **Binding Vow:** Stabilize crumbling alliances
- tem **Mark of Antlers:** Grant temporary authority in chaos
- tem **Revelation:** Pierce illusions but risk unwanted truths

For Cantors The Cantor's Path can be used to "sing" truths or lies:

tem **Hymn of Truth:** Force honesty in social encounters (+1 Effect) tem **Song of Lies:** Create convincing deceptions (+1d to Deception) tem **Chorus of Unity:** Calm conflicts (+1 Position to peacemaking)

For Invokers Ritual magic excels at investigation and information gathering:

tem **Reveal Rites:** Expose hidden connections or concealed truths tem **Ward Rites:** Protect against unwanted revelations tem **Command Rites:** Compel truth from unwilling sources

## largeSESSION FLOW RECOMMENDATIONS

Opening (30 minutes)

tem Establish the chaos through NPC reactions tem Present the initial hook from Livaea or contact tem Start Secrets Unbound timer at 2 segments tem Introduce 23 key NPCs with immediate problems

Midgame (2 hours)

tem Focus on 23 major investigation threads tem Advance timers through player choices tem Introduce Patron offers and complications tem Build toward Red Branch revelation

Climax (1 hour)

tem Library confrontation with Codex tem Patron final gambits tem Player choice determines outcome tem Resolve major NPC storylines

Resolution (30 minutes)

tem Show consequences of player choices tem Award XP for engagement and roleplay tem Discuss potential campaign expansion

*"Ecktoria will never be the same. Whether it becomes a beacon of truth, a web of new connections, or a cautionary tale depends on the choices your players make."*